CHAPTER 8

CHALLENGES OF NATION-BUILDING

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Examine the immediate three core challenges confronting free India in 1947: forging national unity amidst colossal religious and linguistic diversity, establishing institutional democracy via universal adult franchise, and ensuring equitable socio-economic development; analyze the communal trauma and demographic displacement of Partition, the diplomatic integration of 565 princely states orchestrated by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, and the linguistic reorganisation of states.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Three Post-Independence Challenges:** The new nation confronted three simultaneous imperatives: shaping a unified nation accommodating immense diversity, establishing a constitutional representative democracy, and ensuring socio-economic development and poverty eradication for all strata.

• **Partition Displacement and Trauma:** Driven by the Muslim League's Two-Nation Theory, Partition resulted in the Radcliffe boundary demarcations, catastrophic communal violence, forced displacement of nearly 80 lakh people, and long-term refugee rehabilitation challenges.

• **Integration of Princely States:** Faced with the lapse of British paramountcy over 565 princely states, Deputy Prime Minister Sardar Patel secured territorial integration through the Instrument of Accession, employing police action in Hyderabad (Operation Polo, 1948) and a plebiscite in Junagadh.

• **Linguistic Reorganisation of States:** Sparked by Potti Sreeramulu's 56-day hunger strike leading to the creation of Andhra State in 1952, the States Reorganisation Commission (Fazal Ali Commission) led to the States Reorganisation Act of 1956, establishing 14 states and 6 union territories.

ESSENTIAL CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLES & THEORIES

$$\text{Triple Nation-Building Challenges} \iff \{\text{National Unity}, \quad \text{Constitutional Democracy}, \quad \text{Equitable Welfare}\}$$

Three Foundational Imperatives of Free India (1947)

$$\text{Integration of Princely States } (565) \iff \text{Instrument of Accession} \rightarrow \text{Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel}$$

Territorial Consolidation of Indian Sovereignty

$$\text{Hyderabad Annexation } (1948) \iff \text{Peasant Uprising} + \text{Razakar Militia} \rightarrow \text{Operation Polo}$$

Resolution of Nizam's Resistance in Deccan

$$\text{States Reorganisation Act } (1956) \iff 14 \text{ Linguistic States} + 6 \text{ Union Territories} \longleftarrow \text{Fazal Ali Commission}$$

Institutional Redrawing of Internal Administrative Boundaries

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Never confuse the Instrument of Accession with the Merger Agreement; the Instrument of Accession acceded defense, external affairs, and communications to the Union of India without immediate internal integration.

• **Alert:** Remember that Maharaja Bodhachandra Singh of Manipur signed the Instrument of Accession and held India's first election based on universal adult franchise in June 1948, becoming a constitutional monarchy before complete merger.

• **Alert:** Do not state that the States Reorganisation Commission recommended dividing India based on religion; it strictly recommended boundaries based on linguistic and cultural homogeneity.

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. State the three foundational challenges that independent India faced immediately after 15 August 1947. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Challenge of Unity and Diversity:** To shape a united nation while acknowledging and accommodating regional, linguistic, and religious diversities. **[1 Mark]**

• **Challenge of Democratic Governance and Welfare:** To establish a functional representative democracy and ensure inclusive economic development and social justice for all sections of society. **[1 Mark]**

2. What was the 'Instrument of Accession'? Name the national leader whose statesmanship secured its signing by princely rulers. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Legal Document:** A formal legal document signed by the rulers of princely states through which their state agreed to become part of the Union of India. **[1 Mark]**

• **National Leader:** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, the Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister of India. **[1 Mark]**

3. Describe three tragic consequences of the Partition of India in 1947. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Mass Communal Slaughter:** Severe communal riots broke out across Punjab, Bengal, and Delhi, leading to the murder of an estimated 5 to 10 lakh innocent civilians. **[1 Mark]**

• **Colossal Forced Migration:** Approximately 80 lakh people were forced to abandon their ancestral homes, becoming destitute refugees across hastily drawn international borders. **[1 Mark]**

• **Division of Hearts and State Assets:** Severe psychological trauma, systemic violence against women, and the administrative division of physical assets, tables, chairs, railway stock, and police personnel. **[1 Mark]**

4. Explain how the princely state of Hyderabad was integrated into the Indian Union in 1948. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Nizam's Ambition:** The Nizam of Hyderabad sought independent sovereign status and signed a one-year Standstill Agreement with the Indian government in November 1947. **[1 Mark]**

• **People's Uprising and Razakar Atrocities:** Peasantry in Telangana revolted against feudal oppression; in response, the Nizam unleashed his brutal paramilitary force known as the Razakars upon the civilian population. **[1 Mark]**

• **Operation Polo (Police Action):** In September 1948, the Indian military entered Hyderabad to control the Razakars; after several days of fighting, the Nizam surrendered and Hyderabad acceded to India. **[1 Mark]**

5. Trace the events that compelled the Government of India to accept the linguistic reorganisation of states in 1952. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Demand for Vishal Andhra:** Telugu-speaking people demanded a separate state carved out of the bilingual Madras Province to protect their linguistic and political interests. **[1 Mark]**

• **Hunger Strike of Potti Sreeramulu:** Veteran Gandhian leader Potti Sreeramulu went on an indefinite hunger strike, which resulted in his tragic death after 56 days. **[1 Mark]**

• **Widespread Unrest and Creation of Andhra:** His death caused massive public protests, police firings, and political resignations, forcing Prime Minister Nehru to announce the formation of Andhra State in December 1952. **[1 Mark]**

6. Discuss the constitution, recommendations, and impact of the States Reorganisation Commission (SRC) of 1953. **[Score: 4 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Appointment of the Commission:** Following the creation of Andhra, the Central Government appointed the States Reorganisation Commission in December 1953, headed by Justice Fazal Ali with K.M. Panikkar and H.N. Kunzru as members. **[1 Mark]**

• **Core Recommendation:** The commission recommended that state boundaries should reflect linguistic boundaries, concluding that language provided the most rational and democratic administrative unit. **[1 Mark]**

• **States Reorganisation Act of 1956:** Parliament enacted the legislation in 1956, abolishing old colonial distinctions of Part A, B, and C states, and creating 14 states and 6 union territories. **[1 Mark]**

• **Strengthening National Unity:** Contrary to fears of balkanisation, linguistic reorganisation accommodated regional cultural identities within a unified federal framework, deepening democratic citizenship. **[1 Mark]**

7. Highlight the distinctive features of the integration of the princely state of Manipur into India. **[Score: 3 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Constitutional Monarchy:** Maharaja Bodhachandra Singh signed the Instrument of Accession on the assurance of internal autonomy, holding elections under universal adult franchise in June 1948. **[1 Mark]**

• **First Democratic Election:** Manipur was the first part of India to hold an election based on universal adult franchise, creating an elected Legislative Assembly. **[1 Mark]**

• **Merger Agreement Controversy:** In September 1949, the Government of India pressured the Maharaja into signing a Merger Agreement without consulting the elected assembly, causing long-standing public resentment. **[1 Mark]**